Section II

Read this section of the letter on your own. Underline the sentences that tell you about the scenes outside. Describe it to the class.

The scene outside was beautiful with the purple-blue mountains forming a lovely backdrop to the green fields and tea estates. Monkeys were racing all along the tracks. Some were in groups and some had babies **clinging** onto them.

"Look Fatima, doesn't that monkey look cute holding on to its mother's stomach?" I pointed excitedly. The monkeys were really bold. One of them tried to **snatch** a banana that a girl had in her hand, as she leaned out of the window to look at the train curving behind on the track. She let out a **scream** and moved back. Now it was Muthu's turn to snigger.

I looked **entranced** at the misty clouds which covered the mountains and moved in and out of the forests. It looked just like a dream sequence in a movie. Fatima pointed to a bubbling stream with a small waterfall.

"Look Merlin, can you see that bird there? It is such a pretty blue and has such a lovely crown," she said. Just then the train stopped suddenly with a **thud**.

"Oh, what happened?" asked a boy. "Hey, why has the train stopped?" shouted another passenger.

But, nothing could stop Muthu. He and his friends were the first to step out to see what had happened. Geetha madam tried to stop the children running out but they were too excited and begged to be allowed to go out. In the end the whole compartment stepped out. And what a sight greeted their eyes!

Discuss and answer the following questions.

1. Why did the girl scream?
2. Why did Muthu and his friends step out of the train?
3. Describe the beauty of the blue mountain.

GLOSSARY

Clinging	-	Fitting closely to the body
Scream	-	Cry in a high pitch
Snatch	-	Quickly seize (someone) in a rude or eager way
Entranced	-	Filled (someone) with wonder and delight, holding their entire attention
Thud	-	A dull sound, as that of a heavy object striking a solid surface

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